
ZIYAD UQDAH

SENIOR SYSTEMS ENGINEER

Cloud, Data Platforms & Analytics
Azure, DevOps, Migrations &
Integrations



ZIYAD@ZIYADUQDAH.COM



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ZIYADUQDAH.COM



LINKEDIN.COM/IN/ZIYADUQDAH

NEW ORLEANS, LA

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CLOUD & VIRTUALIZATION

Azure, AWS, GCP, VMware, Hyper-V

DATABASES & DATA PLATFORMS

SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MySQL,
Snowflake, Databricks

DEVELOPMENT & DEVOPS

CI/CD, SDLC, QA, Agile, Scrum

BI & AUTOMATION

Microsoft Power Platform,
Microsoft Fabric

EMAIL & COLLABORATION

Exchange, Microsoft 365, Plesk,
SurgeMail

SCRIPTING

PowerShell, Bash, Batch

DATA CENTER & DR

Backup & disaster recovery
planning, colocation management,
capacity planning

SUMMARY

Systems engineer with 19+ years across administration, network engineering, and cloud infrastructure, focused on Microsoft Azure, hybrid architecture, and large-scale migrations. Led SaaS data center migrations and wrote disaster recovery runbooks built against real SLA, RTO, and RPO targets; currently mentors engineers inside a high-volume enterprise support environment. Comfortable across SQL Server, Snowflake, and Databricks, including hands-on version upgrades and serving as SME on data center transitions for SaaS products. Also known for building things at real scale: once ran hosting infrastructure serving roughly 300 domains, 150 websites, and 6,000 mailboxes at peak, fully virtualized a company's server environment, and has worked across VMware, Hyper-V, and the major public cloud platforms.

EXPERIENCE

SENIOR MICROSOFT SYSTEMS ENGINEER, PREMIER SUPPORT / US CLOUD

December 2023 – Present · St. Louis, MO (Remote)

- Serve as a primary escalation point for expert-level Microsoft technology tickets, resolving advanced issues across cloud and on-premises environments.
- Mentor and cross-train Associate and Premier Support Engineers through shadowing and structured onboarding.
- Author and maintain Knowledge Base articles that reduce resolution time for recurring escalations across the support team.
- Lead process adherence and service delivery best practices for the team's support pod, monitoring performance metrics to sustain high client satisfaction.
- Review and interview candidates for the Data Platforms & Analytics and BST teams; author technical interview questions used across the hiring process.
- Support QA process improvements for automated ticket escalation workflows.

MICROSOFT SYSTEMS ENGINEER, PREMIER SUPPORT / US CLOUD

December 2021 – December 2023 · St. Louis, MO

- Delivered client-facing technical guidance across Microsoft cloud and on-premises solutions, supporting cloud-first and mobile-first deployment strategies.
- Supported clients through new deployments and migrations, resolving technical issues that could affect go-live timelines.
- Reduced ticket onboarding and resolution time by providing high-quality case data and proactive account management.
- Named Engineer of the Month, December 2022 (peer-nominated); promoted to Senior Systems Engineer, December 2023.

SYSTEMS ENGINEER, CLOUD OPERATIONS / ACCRUENT

December 2018 – December 2021 · New Orleans, LA

- Served as SME and primary engineer from the SQL team on the data center migration for SaaS application Exesite, supporting production systems across public and private cloud.
- Authored the disaster recovery runbook and method of procedure for Exesite based on product SLAs, RTO, and RPO targets.
 - Led the SQL Server 2016 to 2019 upgrade for SaaS application Lucernex.
- Built and maintained redundant production environments to meet committed SLAs; developed automation scripts to reduce manual configuration work.
- Won the Accruent CloudOps C.H.A.M.P.I.O.N. award, Q1 2020 (peer-nominated, one recipient per quarter).

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NEW ORLEANS, LA

EDUCATION

B.S., Information Technology

Franklin University, 2017

A.A.S., Computer Information Systems and Technology

Jones County Junior College, 2007

HONORS

President's List, Franklin University

Computer Science, Engineering, and
Mathematics Scholarship (CSEMS)
Recipient

Francis T. Edwards Award for
Scholastic Achievement

SYSTEM ADMINISTRATOR II / FIDELITY BANK LA

December 2017 – December 2018 · Greater New Orleans Area

- Designed and rolled out a Microsoft Azure hybrid cloud solution across the Fidelity enterprise.
 - Deployed ConnectWise Manage and ConnectWise Automate enterprise-wide.
- Managed Hyper-V, VMware, and Azure infrastructure, storage networks, and physical servers, plus backup infrastructure (Veeam, Doubletake, TierPoint/LiveVault cloud backup).
- Administered core banking and financial services applications (FIS, Fiserv, Finastra, Banker's Toolbox) alongside Microsoft 365, Active Directory, and Azure AD.

IT SPECIALIST IV / ALL POINTS LOGISTICS (BOEING CONTRACT)

August 2017 – May 2018 · New Orleans, LA (concurrent with Fidelity Bank role)

- Supported Boeing's Space Launch System (SLS) program at NASA's Michoud Assembly Facility, managing VPN/network connectivity, certificate/token/smart card access, and video conferencing systems.
 - Migrated NASA switch ports and workstation block points to Boeing's network standard.
- Replaced VMware ESX 6.0 hosts with ESX 6.5 across the Boeing MAF data center.

SENIOR NETWORK ADMINISTRATOR / MERCHANTS FOODSERVICE

September 2016 – August 2017 · Hattiesburg, MS

- Managed VMware, storage, network, and Windows infrastructure supporting the full company enterprise.
- Installed and configured CentOS 7 servers and open-source tooling, including Nagios Core, MediaWiki, and WordPress; decommissioned legacy systems as part of infrastructure consolidation.

SYSTEM ADMINISTRATOR I / C SPIRE

October 2014 – September 2016 · Hattiesburg, MS

- Migrated MegaGate systems (file shares, backups, workstations, applications, servers) into the C Spire enterprise following acquisition.
- Managed multi-site VMware vCenter/ESX infrastructure and enterprise systems including Exchange, Active Directory, and Nagios.

SYSTEMS ADMINISTRATOR / MEGAGATE BROADBAND

August 2012 – October 2014 · Hattiesburg, MS

- Managed hosting infrastructure at peak scale of roughly 300 hosted domains, 150 websites, and 6,000 mailboxes across Plesk, Surgemail, and Edgewise spam filtering.
- Fully virtualized the company's server environment, eliminating all remaining physical servers.
- Administered VMware infrastructure, storage, and Windows/Unix systems, including MySQL, SQL Server, BIND, Apache, and IIS.

NETWORK SUPPORT SPECIALIST / MEGAGATE BROADBAND

August 2010 – August 2012 · Hattiesburg, MS

- Delivered Tier 2 technical support across Metro Ethernet, T1, DSL, VoIP, and hosting products; promoted to Systems Administrator in August 2012.

IT SUPPORT TECHNICIAN / PINE BELT MENTAL HEALTHCARE RESOURCES

August 2009 – August 2010 · Hattiesburg, MS

- Migrated all production systems to the corporate office data center and maintained Exchange, Plesk, and Active Directory for agency operations.

NETWORK TECHNICIAN / SERVICE MANAGEMENT GROUP

January 2007 – January 2009 · Hattiesburg, MS

- Automated manual server processes with VBScript and batch scripting; administered SQL Server, Active Directory, and homegrown .NET/ASP applications.
- Contributed to a development team building a SQL-backed web application for archiving user-uploaded video content.